



Sikkim Festival 2009 at New Delhi

SIKKIM: THE CYNOSURE OF ALL EYES

Best Award in Education	2004	India Today Group
Best Award in Education and Investment Climate	2005	India Today Group
Best Eco-Tourism Destination	2005	Hospitality India
Third best performing State in Panchayati Raj	2005-06	GOI
Safe Transportation Award	2005-06, 2007-08	Ministry of Transport, GOI
Skoch Challenger Award for best use of Information Technology	2006	GOI
Best Tourism Performing State in the North East for 7 consecutive years	1998-99, 2006-2007	Ministry of Tourism, GOI
Cooperative Excellence Award	2006	National Cooperative Dev. Corp.
Most Picturesque Destination	2007	Today's Traveler Platinum Award
Diamond States of India Award in citizens security and Justice	2008	IBN 7 Network
Best Example of Community based Tourism	2008	CNBC Aawaz
Emerging Tourism State	2008	Today's Traveler Platinum
Best tourism State in best Adventure tourism	2008	Safari India National Tourism
First Nirmal Gram Puraskar (First 100 % covered sanitation state in the country)	2008	GOI
4th JRD TATA Memorial Award	2008	Population Foundation of India
Best Adventure Tourism Destination	2008	Pacific Area Travel Writers Association (PATWA) International Award at ITB in Berlin

SOCIO-CULTURAL PROGRESS

- Bhujel, Gurung, Limbu, Mangar, Kirat Khambu Rai, Sunuwar, Tamangs Sanyasis, Thamis, Jogis inducted in the OBC category. Same status extended to Chhetri, Bahun and Newar communities
- Limboos and Tamangs inducted as STs
- 7%, 33%, 21%, and 14% job reservation for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Most Backward Classes and OBCs, respectively.
- 30%, 3%, 3% and 2% job reservation for women, ex-servicemen, physically challenged, sports persons/artists respectively.
- Bhutia, Lepcha, Limbu, Nepali languages being taught upto college level.
- Tamang, Gurung, Kiran Khambu Rai, Sherpa, Mangar, Newar and Sunuwar languages recognized as State language
- Old age pension to the eligible senior citizens of the State enhanced from Rs. 100 to Rs. 400.
- Daily wages of manual labourers increased from Rs. 20 to Rs. 150
- Senior citizens of 65 years of age and above are provided 10 kg. of rice per month free of cost under CM Annapurna Programme
- Free travel by state owned buses for women of 65 years and men of 70 years and above
- "Parijat Leprosy Eradication Centre" constructed
- A 132 feet statue of Guru Padmasambhava installed in Samdruptse, Namchi- tallest such statue in the world
- Spiritual destinations including Char Dhaam at Solaphok with 108 feet tall statue of Lord Shiva, installation of 108 feet tall statue of Lord Buddha at Ravangla, Sai Mandir at Daramden completed
- A life size statue of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar installed at the Sikkim Legislative Assembly premises. Sri Junga Mang-him and statue at Hee Bermiok, monastery-cum-guest house at Bodh Gaya in Bihar, Lepcha traditional house at Namprikdang, Dzongu, Rodu-khim of Kirat Khambu Rais, Sikkim Akademi, Village Libraries, Children Library etc.
- Cultural festivals of different ethnic community declared as Gazetted holidays including Tendong-Lho Rum Faat, Tamu Lochar, Sakewa etc.
- Different stretch of road and different Schools named after prominent Sikkimese like war veteran Ganju Lama, VC, L.D. Kazi Khansarpa, Nayan Tshering Lepcha etc.
- Indian Nepalis as minority community through resolution in Sikkim Legislative Assembly



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